

Welcome

Getting Started with AI

PRESENTER:

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Workshop Overview + Housekeeping

BY THE END, YOU WILL:

- Understand what generative AI is and where it already shows up
- Practice writing and improving prompts on your phone
- Learn when to verify, slow down, and protect your privacy
- Leave with one real task to try this week

3 X 1-HOUR SESSIONS:

- **Session 1:** Foundations, safety, and privacy
- **Session 2:** Prompting, phone demos, and guided practice
- **Session 3:** Everyday workflows and your action plan

WORKSHOP ENVIRONMENT

- Open, inclusive, and curiosity-driven
- Questions and help are welcome at any time

HOUSEKEEPING

- Wi-Fi: We have none in the building yet
- Activities are designed for use on your phone
- Pair up if you don't have a device or account
- Raise your hand anytime if you need help

Session 1

Foundations: What AI is + how to use it safely

Session 1 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Welcome + quick intros (5)
- AI in daily life (10)
- Core vocabulary (10)
- Why AI feels different now (10)
- What ChatGPT is / isn't (10)
- Privacy + safety basics (10)
- Wrap + prep for Session 2 (5)

AI in our world

Where do you think AI might already be helping you in daily life—without you even realizing it?

A few examples include:

 **Photo Tagging & Face Recognition** Your phone or social media app automatically groups your photos by faces or places—powered by AI.

 **Search Suggestions** As you type, search engines guess what you mean based on past searches and trends—thank AI for that.

 **GPS & Maps** AI predicts traffic, suggests faster routes, and updates real-time arrival times.

 **Streaming Recommendations** Netflix, YouTube, Spotify, etc., use AI to suggest shows or songs based on what you've watched or listened to.

 **Voice Assistants** Siri, Alexa, and Google Assistant recognize speech, interpret commands, and even hold mini conversations.

 **Autocorrect & Smart Text Prediction** Your phone suggests the next word or fixes typos as you type—that's AI anticipating your intent.

Common AI Vocabulary

- **AI (Artificial Intelligence)**

A computer system that can perform tasks usually requiring human intelligence (like understanding language or recognizing images).

- **ML (Machine Learning)**

A type of AI where computers learn from data and improve over time without being explicitly programmed.

- **GPT (Generative Pre-trained Transformer)**

A large language model trained on tons of text to predict and generate human-like responses.

- **LLM (Large Language Model)**

A type of AI trained on massive text data to understand and generate human language.

- **Token**

A piece of a word or character that the AI processes; for example, “chatting” might be split into “chat” and “ting”.

- **Prompt**

The input or question you give to an AI—what you type to start the conversation.

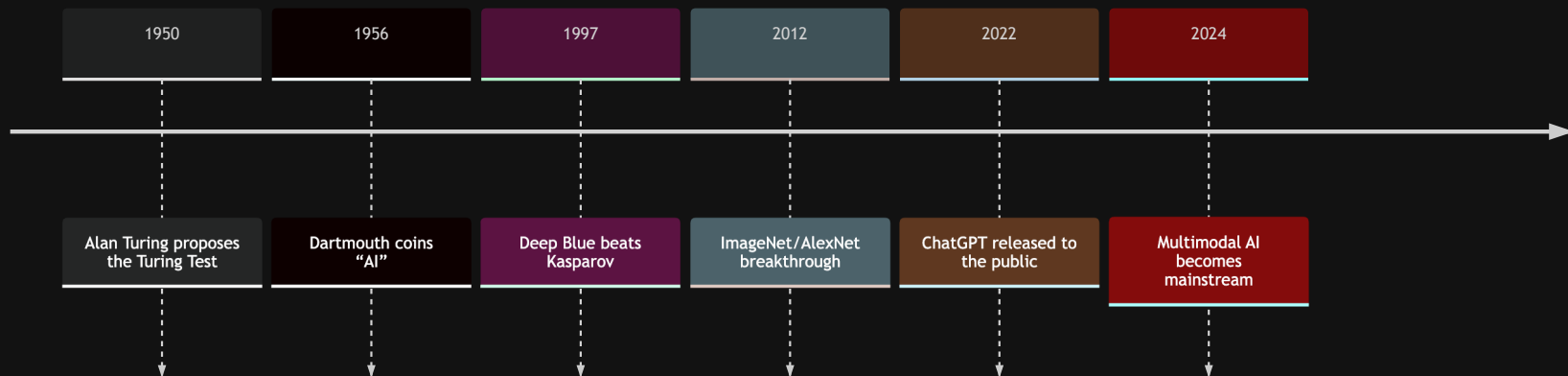
- **Training Data**

The information (usually lots of text) used to teach the AI how to understand and respond.

- **Inference**

The process of the AI generating a response based on your input—it’s “thinking” time for the model.

Moments That Matter (AI)



- AI is not brand new.
- What changed recently is **access**: better tools, lower cost, and easier use on phones and laptops.
- For this workshop, the key date is **2022** when conversational AI became easy for the public to try.

Why AI Feels Different Now

- **You can talk to it naturally**

It feels more like messaging a helper than programming a machine Conversational Demo

- **It works on the devices people already own**

Most people can try it on a phone in minutes.

- **It can handle more than plain text**

Some tools can work with voice, images, files, and web results.

- **It is built into more apps and services**

Search, writing help, photo tools, and assistants now include AI features.

- **The quality can be surprisingly good**

That makes it useful, but also easy to trust too quickly.

- **Your judgment still matters**

Useful does not mean accurate, fair, private, or appropriate.

What AI Chat Is and Isn't

What AI chat is good at

- **Drafting and rewriting** → Messages, emails, posts, reminders, and first drafts.
- **Summarizing and organizing** → Turns long text into bullet points, checklists, or short summaries.
- **Planning and brainstorming** → Helps with errands, meal plans, travel ideas, and next steps.
- **Explaining concepts** → Breaks down unfamiliar topics in plain language.
- **Translating and adapting tone** → Rewrites for clearer, friendlier, shorter, or simpler communication.

Limits and cautions

- **Can be wrong while sounding confident** → Always verify important facts.
- **Not a replacement for experts** → Medical, legal, and financial decisions need trusted sources.
- **May miss local or recent details** → Prices, policies, events, and deadlines can change quickly.
- **Does not know your life unless you tell it** → Missing context leads to generic or off-base answers.
- **Bias and blind spots exist** → Double-check tone, assumptions, and fairness.

Privacy & Safety Basics

- **Do not paste private, financial, medical, or account information.**
- **Remove names, IDs, addresses, account numbers, and passwords.**
- **Get consent before including someone else's messages, photo, or personal details.**
- **On a phone, check screenshots and photos carefully** before uploading anything.
- **Use summaries or excerpts instead of full documents whenever possible.**
- **Review the tool's privacy settings** and opt out of training use if that matters for your situation.
- **Remember:** "Anonymous" is not always anonymous if the situation is very specific.
- **When in doubt, leave it out** and ask in a more general way.

Safer Prompt Example

- **Too much:**

"Summarize this email from my child's teacher. Her name is ____ and our phone number is ____."

- **Safer:**

"Summarize this school message in three bullets. Remove names and personal details. Tell me if there is any action item or deadline."

- **Better habit:**

Share only the part you need help with, not the whole thread.

Session 1 Wrap

One takeaway: What surprised you most about AI today?

One caution: What will you *avoid* sharing with AI tools?

Session 2

Prompting + Practice: getting consistently useful results

Session 2 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Quick recap (5)
- One phone demo from start to finish (10)
- What makes a prompt useful (10)
- Prompt patterns (15)
- Guided phone practice (15)
- Share-outs + Q&A (5)
- Take-home task (last 5)

Everyday Tasks That Work Well on a Phone

-  **Write or rewrite a message**
Ask for a text, email, follow-up, or reminder in a specific tone.
-  **Plan something practical**
Organize errands, meals, trips, study time, or a busy week.
-  **Understand something faster**
Get a plain-language explanation, a summary, or a short quiz.
-  **Translate or simplify**
Rewrite for a different audience, reading level, or language.
-  **Turn a messy idea into a checklist**
Great for starting when you are stuck or overwhelmed.
-  **Still verify before acting**
Helpful first draft, not a final answer.

Live Demo Flow

Start with a real task

Ask in a simple, natural sentence

Add missing details

Ask for a better format

Check the result before you use it

EXAMPLE PHONE TASK

"Write a short text to reschedule my dentist appointment for next week."

Then improve it by adding tone, timing, and word limit.

Pick a Starter Task



Message someone

Reschedule, follow up, thank someone, or ask for help.



Plan your day or week

Ask for a simple schedule that fits your real constraints.



Plan meals or groceries

Use ingredients you already have and a budget you can afford.



Explain something clearly

Ask for a plain-language explanation with examples.



Brainstorm options

Gifts, events, side projects, or questions to ask before a decision.



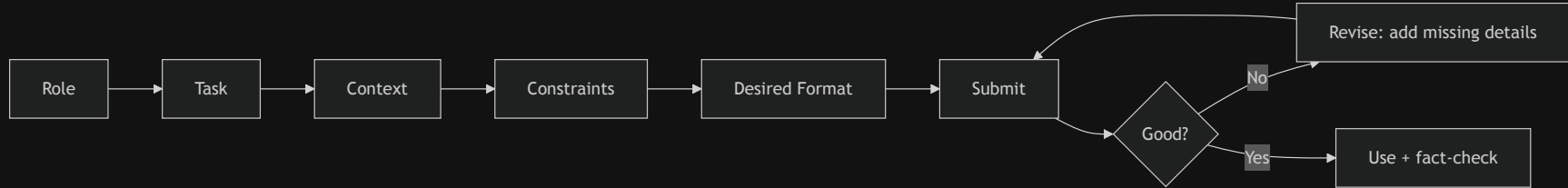
Translate or adapt

Change language, tone, length, or reading level.

When the First Answer Misses

- Add **context**: who, what, where, why
- Add **constraints**: budget, time, tone, word count
- Add **format**: text message, bullets, checklist, table
- Add **audience**: friend, coworker, parent, student, customer
- Ask for **another version** instead of starting over

How to write a good prompt



- **Be specific**

"Write a short text asking to reschedule my appointment" works better than "Help me write something."

- **Use natural language**

You do not need special commands. Just describe the task like you would to a helpful assistant.

- **Set the tone**

Say if you want it friendly, professional, calm, short, direct, or simple.

- **Give constraints**

Include details like audience, deadline, budget, or maximum length.

Prompt Engineering

✖ Poor Prompt

"Write a text to my landlord."

👍 A little better

"Write a polite text to my landlord asking when the dishwasher will be fixed."

🎓 Pro-Level

"Write a short, polite text to my landlord, Jordan.

The dishwasher has not worked since Monday.

I already reported it once.

Ask for an update and suggest a repair window after 5 p.m.

Keep it under 70 words and sound calm, not angry."

Prompt Ideas You Can Try Right Now

✉ Write a polite message to reschedule my dentist appointment.

👨‍🍳 Give me 3 simple dinners from these ingredients: [list].

🧠 Explain what a deductible is in plain language.

📅 Plan a low-cost day trip near [my city] under [\$ amount].

📝 Turn these messy notes into a checklist: [paste notes].

🌐 Translate this text into [language] and keep it friendly.

Group Activity - Try It on Your Phone

- **Timebox: 10 minutes**

- Open your AI app or mobile browser
- Pick **one real task** from the previous slide
- Start with a simple prompt
- Improve it by adding:
 - context
 - constraints
 - desired format
- Save your best version with a screenshot or note
- Pair up if you need a device or account

SHARE BACK

- What task did you choose?
- What changed when you improved the prompt?
- What part of the answer still needed your judgment?

Take-Home Task

GOAL (20–30 MINUTES)

Pick one real task you do at work, school, home, church, or in your community and use AI to improve it.

Choose one:

- Draft an email/message
- Plan a week or event
- Learn something (explain + quiz me)
- Create something useful (recipe, outline, checklist, flyer text)

WHAT TO BRING BACK

- Your **best prompt**
- The **best AI output** or a screenshot
- **2 improvements** you made
- One thing you **still had to check or fix**

Session 3

Apply + Grow: practical workflows and your next step

Session 3 Agenda (60 minutes)

- Quick recap of Sessions 1 + 2 (5)
- Homework share-out (10)
- Three repeatable AI workflows (15)
- Choosing the right tool for the job (10)
- Helpful phone features (10)
- Your 7-day action plan (5)
- Encouragement + next steps (5)

Quick Recap: Sessions 1 + 2

SESSION 1

- AI is already part of everyday tools and apps
- AI chat is useful, but it can still be wrong
- Privacy: remove names and sensitive details
- Your judgment matters more than the tool

SESSION 2

- Better prompts give more useful results
- Good prompts include context, constraints, and format
- Revising the prompt is part of the process
- AI is most helpful when you use it on a real task

Homework Share-Out

Please share with the group:

- The real task you tried
- Your most useful prompt revision
- What you still had to check or fix
- One way you might use AI again this week

Practical Workflows: AI in Action

■ COMMUNICATION WORKFLOW

Draft — Ask for a text, email, or short message.

Refine — Adjust the tone, length, and audience.

Verify — Check names, dates, facts, and next steps.

■ PLANNING WORKFLOW

Brainstorm — Ask for options, ideas, or a rough plan.

Filter — Narrow it to what fits your budget, time, or energy.

Expand — Turn the best option into a checklist or weekly plan.

📖 LEARNING WORKFLOW

Ask — "Explain [topic] in plain language."

Clarify — Ask for examples, steps, or a short quiz.

Verify — Confirm important facts with a trusted source.

🧠 THE GOLDEN RULE

AI gives you a **first draft**, not a final answer.

You bring the judgment, context, and final decision.

Focus on the task, not the brand

- **For research, try Google Gemini**

Useful when you want to explore a topic, compare ideas, and gather information to review further.

- **For writing and chat, try ChatGPT**

Strong for drafting messages, rewriting tone, brainstorming, summarizing, and everyday back-and-forth help.

- **For coding, try Claude**

Helpful for explaining code, debugging, drafting functions, and working through technical problems step by step.

- **No tool is perfect for everything**

Start with the task you need to do, then choose the tool that fits it best.

A Simple Tool Check

- Does it work well on **your phone**?
- Is it **easy enough** that you will actually use it again?
- Does it fit your **budget**?
- Does it handle the kind of task you want: text, voice, image, or research?
- Are the **privacy settings** acceptable for your situation?
- Can you tell when you still need to **verify** the answer?

Helpful Phone Features to Explore

IMAGE HELP

- Brainstorm flyer text, social captions, or visual ideas
- Improve wording before you create or post anything

VOICE

- Talk instead of type when your hands are busy or you are capturing ideas quickly
- Great for rough drafts, not for blind trust

CAMERA / PHOTO INPUT

- Ask for help reading, describing, or organizing what is in an image
- Double-check photos for names, addresses, or private details before uploading

Your AI Starter Plan

CHOOSE YOUR FIRST USE CASE

- ☐ Email / messages
- ☐ Planning / scheduling
- ☐ Learning / research
- ☐ Community / volunteer work
- ☐ Other: _____

CHOOSE YOUR TOOL

- ☐ ChatGPT
- ☐ Claude
- ☐ Gemini
- ☐ Other: _____

WRITE YOUR FIRST PROMPT

Use this template:

"I need help with [task].

Context: [relevant details].

Keep it [tone / length / reading level].

Format it as [text / bullets / checklist / table]."

DEFINE SUCCESS

- I will try this by: _____
- I will know it helped if: _____

KEEP ONE SAFETY HABIT

Remove names and sensitive details before you paste anything.

What's Next

KEEP GOING WITH THE BASICS

- Start with **one small, real task**
- Keep what saves time
- Ignore what adds friction
- Verify what matters
- Let practice build your confidence

EXPLORE DEEPER DIVES

- **Claude Desktop** — for a stronger desktop workflow and deeper document or project work
- **Codex desktop app** — if you want a dedicated AI coding workspace and agent-based software help
- **Browser integration helpers** — for summarizing pages, rewriting text, and pulling key information while you browse
- **OpenClaw** — if you are curious about a more advanced, self-hosted personal AI assistant

Questions?

Thanks for your time.

AI works best when it supports your judgment, your values, and the work you already care about.

- ✨ Start with one small, real task
- 🧠 Keep your judgment in the loop
- ↺ Revise once before giving up
- 🌱 Let practice build your confidence

You do not need perfect prompts to begin. You just need curiosity and one useful next step.

